

Russell Dudek

Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania

Candidate Vision

Interview Brief

EXECUTIVE OPERATIONS LEADER · HIGH-RELIABILITY SYSTEMS · CROSS-FUNCTIONAL EXECUTION

Operator-technologist who makes complex work visible, connects technical and business teams, and builds operating mechanisms that turn emerging technology into adopted, measurable outcomes. Leadership experience spans high-reliability electronics, 24/7 scaled operations, regulated autonomous systems, industrial logistics, robotics, machine vision, quality systems, and AI-enabled workflow transformation.

Executive Operating Cadence High-Reliability Operations Decision & Escalation Architecture Engineering-Operations Integration
Quality Systems & Root Cause Cross-Functional Dependency Management AI-Enabled Workflow Design Change Adoption

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Vape-Jet

2025–Present

Director of Operations

- Lead AI-first operating transformation across production, purchasing, quality, customer success, support, engineering issue flow, ERP/Odoo, Jira, HubSpot, Slack, telemetry, and AI-assisted workflows.
- Connect factory, field, customer, and machine-fleet signals into prioritized work, earlier risk detection, cleaner handoffs, dashboards, standard work, training, and accountability.
- Operate in a software-enabled robotics and machine-vision environment with approximately 1,000 fielded robots informing support and operating feedback loops.

Compunetics

2000–2013

Director of Operations and Engineering Management

- Progressed through R&D program management, production management, strategic acquisition, operations management, and director-level leadership.
- Led engineering, manufacturing, quality, customer delivery, and complex technical programs in advanced electronics and high-reliability environments.
- Built quality systems, standard work, root-cause practices, performance measures, and process controls.
- Collaborated with high-consequence customers and partners including DoD, CERN, Intel, and AMD; published industry articles, delivered technical talks, and participated in the HyperTransport Consortium.

Amazon

2014–2018

Operations Management / Site Leader

- Led launch and execution for Amazon Prime Pittsburgh in a 24/7 customer-backward operating environment supporting approximately five million second-day orders annually.
- Built leadership routines, labor planning, throughput visibility, escalation paths, standard work, and operating mechanisms.
- Applied Lean and Gemba practices across safety, quality, throughput, customer experience, and team engagement.
- Contributed to logistics innovation through Prime Air research and Amazon Flex geolocation concepts.

ZeusVu

2018–2022

Chief Pilot, Autonomous Systems and Aerial Data Operations

- Led regulated drone operations across medical, energy, logistics, real-estate, and restricted-airspace contexts with a 100% safety record and no FAA incidents.
- Developed TensorFlow-based concepts for automated aerial inventory and computer-vision-enabled field intelligence.
- Designed medical drone delivery and chain-of-custody concepts connecting technology, risk, stakeholders, and governed execution.

OPERATING MECHANISMS RELEVANT TO THE MANDATE

Visibility: commitment confidence, constraint aging, throughput, issue flow, and decision logs.

Learning: recurring-failure analysis, reusable standards, planning assumptions, and closed-loop verification.

Governance: thresholds, escalation routes, decision rights, standard work, and root cause.

Adoption: frontline-informed design, trusted-source reuse, training, accountability, and meeting-burden reduction.

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COMPLEMENTARY LEADERSHIP DEPTH

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ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

DudeWorth

2017–Present

Founder / AI and Automation Advisor

- Develop AI-readiness and opportunity frameworks assessing value, feasibility, data readiness, governance, adoption burden, reuse, and time-to-value.
- Design agentic workflow patterns using structured context, retrieval, AI agents, human judgment, escalation, decision records, evaluation, and governance rails.
- Advise on AI-enabled operations, logistics technology, warehouse automation, AMRs, ASRS, cobots, transportation systems, network analysis, and workflow design.

Cardinal Building Products

2021–2023

Regional Director

- Built the company's first remote regional operation and modernized distributed customer, CRM, commercial, fulfillment, logistics, digital marketing, SEO, and online-buying workflows.
- Advanced AI-enhanced transportation-management and route-planning concepts.

LEADERSHIP & CIVIC WORK

Enviro Social Capital

2014–2017

Chairman of the Board

- Co-founded and led a public-private impact initiative focused on sustainable infrastructure, green finance, and civic transformation.
- Helped shape and evaluate a \$200 million Social Impact Bond feasibility concept for Pittsburgh sewage and green-infrastructure improvement.

IEEE

2012–2016

CMPT and EDS Pittsburgh Chapter Chair

- Led regional technology programming connecting industry, academia, STEM outreach, electronics, manufacturing, and emerging technology.
- Organized conferences, seminars, business tours, and technical programming.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

- **University of Pittsburgh** · Bachelor of Science
- IBM Enterprise Design Thinking Practitioner
- Six Sigma Certification
- OSHA 10

TECHNICAL & OPERATING TOOLKIT

Agentic AI · LLM workflows · RAG patterns · Human-in-the-loop design · Python · SQL · JavaScript · TensorFlow · Tableau · ERP/Odoo workflows · Jira · Confluence · HubSpot · Slack · GIS and mapping workflows

ROLE-ALIGNED THROUGH-LINE

High-reliability technical operations → scaled customer-backward execution → regulated autonomous systems → distributed operations → AI-enabled robotics transformation. The connecting work: visibility, decision quality, operating cadence, standards, escalation, and adoption.

EVIDENCE BOUNDARY

No claim of direct nuclear-industry experience. The candidacy is based on adjacent high-consequence operating experience and verified transferability.

ROLE-RELEVANCE MAP

Executive coherence

Vape-Jet + Amazon

Operating cadence, cross-functional visibility, escalation, and adoption.

Technical consequence

Compunetics + ZeusVu

High-reliability systems, quality controls, regulated execution, and authority boundaries.

AI and workflow leverage

DudeWorth + Vape-Jet

Agentic workflow patterns, human judgment, evaluation, governance, and real operating work.

Transfer boundary: This resume does not claim direct nuclear-industry experience. It presents verified adjacent evidence in high-reliability operations, regulated execution, quality systems, executive cadence, and cross-functional mechanism building.